Ideation Phase
Define the Problem Statements

Date	24 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Customer Problem Statement Template

A customer problem statement describes a difficulty from the point of view of the person who experiences it, before any solution is chosen. Each statement below names who is affected, what they are trying to do, what stops them, why it happens and how it makes them feel.

Project Context

An employee, Michael Hoefer, cannot connect to the Corporate VPN from his home office. A Service Desk agent, Beth Anglin, has to record the incident, classify it and find a known fix. The incident then goes to the Network support group, where Level 2 technician David Loo investigates it, raises an emergency change request, creates a child incident for the recurring error, documents the cause and resolution, and creates a knowledge article. Support lead Samantha Bordwell follows the incident through the watch list and the SLA. Each hand-off in this lifecycle is a place where details can be lost or work can be repeated.

Format

I am (Customer) > I'm trying to > But > Because > Which makes me feel

PS-1: Reporting and classifying an incident

I am (Customer)	An employee, such as Michael Hoefer, who cannot connect to the Corporate VPN from home.
I'm trying to	Report the problem so that support can start working on it straight away.
But	I am not sure which details matter, so the incident can be logged with a thin description and the wrong category or urgency.
Because	Support needs the category, subcategory, urgency, service, service offering and configuration item before the incident can be routed.
Which makes me feel	Unsure that my problem has been understood and worried that help will be late.

PS-2: Finding a known fix quickly

I am (Customer)	A Service Desk agent such as Beth Anglin, handling calls and incidents.
I'm trying to	Resolve or advance the incident using existing knowledge instead of starting from nothing.
But	Useful knowledge articles are hard to find from inside the incident, and I end up searching separately.
Because	Knowledge is not linked to the incident record, so relevant articles are not suggested from the short description.
Which makes me feel	Pressured and frustrated when the caller is waiting and the answer already exists somewhere.

PS-3: Reassignment and ownership

I am (Customer)	A Service Desk agent who cannot resolve the incident at first level.
I'm trying to	Hand the incident to the Network support group and keep the right people informed.
But	After reassignment it is unclear who owns the incident, and interested people do not receive updates.
Because	The assigned individual must be cleared when the group changes, and watchers and work-note followers must be added by hand.
Which makes me feel	Concerned about delays, duplicate follow-up and unclear ownership.

PS-4: Investigation, change and recurring issues

I am (Customer)	A Level 2 technician such as David Loo, investigating an escalated incident.
I'm trying to	Find the cause, get an emergency change approved when the fix needs one, and track repeat reports of the same error.
But	The change request, the updated configuration item and the repeat reports are tracked in different places and are easy to lose.

Because	A fix such as restarting a service needs an emergency change, and repeat reports need child incidents linked to the parent.
Which makes me feel	Frustrated and uncertain whether every related record has been connected.

PS-5: Resolution, knowledge and SLA visibility

I am (Customer)	An incident owner or support lead, such as Samantha Bordwell, responsible for service quality.
I'm trying to	See the SLA, confirm the cause and resolution are recorded, and reuse the fix for the next user.
But	Resolution details are sometimes missing, no knowledge article is created, and SLA status is hard to see on the incident.
Because	Cause, resolution notes, knowledge creation and task SLAs are not captured in one consistent flow.
Which makes me feel	Worried that delays go unnoticed and that the same issue will be solved from scratch again.

Problem Statement Analysis

Problem Area	Customer Difficulty	Underlying Need
Incident creation and classification	Missing details and inconsistent category, urgency and service.	A complete, consistently classified incident record.
Knowledge support	Known fixes are not found from the incident.	Agent Assist suggesting articles that can be attached.
Reassignment and escalation	Unclear ownership and no updates for watchers.	Routing to the right group with watch and work-note lists.
Change and child incidents	Change requests and repeat reports tracked separately.	Emergency change and child incidents linked to the parent.
Resolution and knowledge	Cause, resolution and reusable knowledge not recorded.	Documented cause and resolution, and a knowledge article.
SLA and related records	SLA progress and linked records hard to see.	Task SLAs and related records visible on the incident.

Consolidated Customer Problem Statement

Employees, Service Desk agents, Level 2 technicians and support leads need one consistent way to manage an IT incident from the first report to its resolution. When classification, knowledge, assignment, change requests, child incidents, resolution details and SLA information are not handled together, incidents are delayed, ownership is unclear, work is repeated and progress is hard to follow. This project addresses that by automating and standardising the incident lifecycle in ServiceNow.

Key Findings

- Callers need a simple way to report an issue, and agents need classification fields that are filled in the same way every time.
- Agents need relevant knowledge articles inside the incident so they can resolve faster.

- Reassignment must move the incident to the right group, clear the old owner and keep watchers informed.
- Level 2 technicians need the emergency change request and child incidents linked to the parent incident.
- Owners and support leads need the cause, resolution, knowledge article and SLA recorded and visible.

Ideation Phase Output

These problem statements define what the ServiceNow solution must achieve: structured incident creation and classification, Agent Assist knowledge integration, reassignment to Level 2 teams, emergency change and child incident creation, documented cause and resolution, knowledge article creation, and SLA and related-record tracking. They are the input for the brainstorming and prioritisation activity that follows.